



2026

History & Geography

Grade 6 — Primary School Achievement Certificate

Specimen Paper 2

Focus: British Rule, Slavery & Indentured Labour • Climate of Mauritius

Duration: 1 hour 45 minutes **Total Marks:** 100

Candidate Name: _____

School: _____

Index Number: _____

INSTRUCTIONS TO CANDIDATES

1. Answer **ALL** questions in all sections.
2. Write your answers in the spaces provided.
3. This paper has **FOUR sections**: A, B, C and D.
4. Section A: Map Work and Geography — 25 marks
5. Section B: History of Mauritius (British Rule, Slavery & Indentured Labour) — 35 marks
6. Section C: Geography of Mauritius (Climate) — 25 marks
7. Section D: Civics and Heritage — 15 marks
8. Read each question carefully before answering.
9. Marks for each question are shown in brackets [].
10. Do not open this booklet until you are told to do so.

SECTION A — MAP WORK AND GEOGRAPHY [25 marks]

1. Study the rainfall map of Mauritius below and answer the questions that follow.

[12]

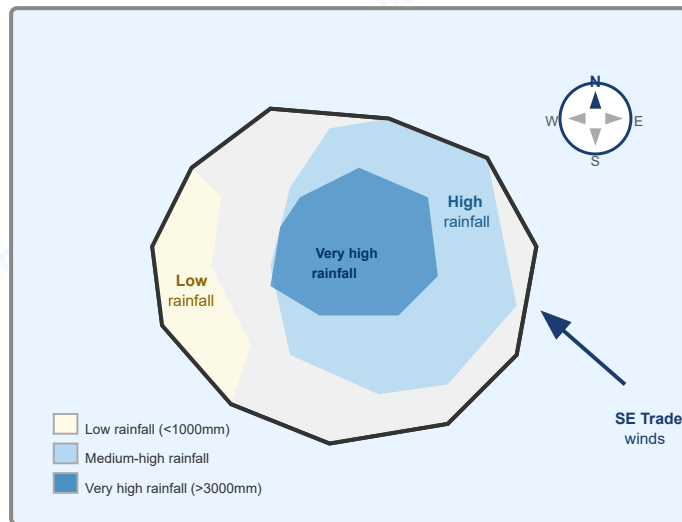


Fig. 2 — Simplified rainfall distribution map of Mauritius

- (a) Which part of Mauritius receives the highest rainfall? [1]

- (b) Which part of Mauritius receives the lowest rainfall? [1]

- (c) From which direction do the trade winds blow, according to the map? [1]

- (d) Explain why the western side of Mauritius receives less rainfall than the eastern side. Use the map to help you. [3]

- (e) Name the effect shown on the rainfall map where mountains cause one side to be wet and the other to be dry. [1]

- (f) Sugar cane farming is most successful in the drier, low-lying areas. Using the map, suggest in which part of Mauritius sugar cane would grow best. Give a reason. [2]

- (g) Between which months does Mauritius receive most of its rainfall? [1]

- (h) Name **two** weather hazards that Mauritius faces during the hot, wet season. [2]

2. Answer the following questions about the geography of the Indian Ocean region.

[13]

- (a) Name **two** islands that are part of the Republic of Mauritius (apart from the main island). [2]

- (b) Tick ONE correct answer. What is the approximate area of the island of Mauritius? [1]

- ☐ A 500 km²
☐ B 1,050 km²
☐ C 2,040 km²
☐ D 5,000 km²

- (c) Name **two** countries nearest to Mauritius in the Indian Ocean region. [2]

(d) What are the approximate latitude and longitude coordinates of Mauritius? [2]

(e) Explain how Mauritius's position in the Indian Ocean made it important to European powers in the 18th century. [3]

(f) Name **one** physical feature that makes Port Louis a good natural harbour. [1]

(g) State **two** uses of the Indian Ocean for Mauritius today. [2]

SECTION B — HISTORY: BRITISH RULE, SLAVERY AND INDENTURED LABOUR [35 marks]

3. Answer the following questions about British rule in Mauritius.

[10]

(a) In which year did Britain capture Mauritius from France? [1]

(b) Where did the British land when they captured Mauritius? [1]

(c) Who was the first British Governor of Mauritius? Name **one** important policy he introduced. [2]

(d) Tick ONE correct answer. The British kept French laws in Mauritius because: [1]

- ☐ A They did not know English law
- ☐ B They wanted to keep the French-speaking settlers happy and prevent rebellion
- ☐ C French law was better than English law
- ☐ D The French refused to leave the island

(e) Complete the timeline of British rule in Mauritius. [5]

- **1810** — Britain captures Mauritius; island renamed _____
- **1814** — Treaty of _____ formally gives Mauritius to Britain
- **1835** — _____ (Slavery abolished; "Apprenticeship" period begins)
- **1838** — End of the Apprenticeship period; formerly enslaved people become _____
- **1835–1924** — Arrival of about _____ indentured labourers, mainly from _____

4. Answer the following questions about slavery and the abolition of slavery in Mauritius.

[14]

- (a) In which year was slavery officially abolished in Mauritius? [1]

- (b) What was the "Apprenticeship" period? Why did enslaved people have to work as apprentices after 1835? [2]

- (c) Read Source A carefully and answer the questions below. [6]

Source A: Conditions of enslaved people in Mauritius

"Enslaved people in Mauritius had no legal rights. They could be bought and sold, beaten and punished at the will of their owners. They were forced to work on sugar plantations from sunrise to sunset with little rest. Their children were also enslaved. Despite these terrible conditions, enslaved people found ways to preserve their culture, including through music, dance and religion. Some escaped into the mountains, where they formed communities of Maroons — free people who refused to submit to slavery. The most famous place associated with Maroon resistance is Le Morne Brabant."

- (i) According to Source A, name **two** ways in which enslaved people were treated badly. [2]

- (ii) What were "Maroons"? According to Source A, where did Maroons form their communities? [2]

- (iii) How did enslaved people preserve their culture according to Source A? Give **two** examples. [2]

- (d) Why is 1 February celebrated in Mauritius each year? What is its official name? [2]

- (e) Name the UNESCO World Heritage Site in Mauritius linked to the resistance of enslaved people. [1]

- (f) Tick ONE correct answer. The Maroons were: [1]

- ☐ A European traders who visited Mauritius
- ☐ B Enslaved people who escaped and lived in freedom
- ☐ C French soldiers stationed in Mauritius
- ☐ D Indian labourers who refused to work

5. Answer the following questions about indentured labour in Mauritius.

[11]

- (a) Why did the British bring indentured labourers to Mauritius after 1835? [2]

- (b) Where did most indentured labourers come from? Name the main country and **one** other. [2]

- (c) Read Source B carefully and answer the questions below. [5]

Source B: The indentured labour system

"Indentured labourers signed a contract (an indenture) agreeing to work in Mauritius for a fixed period, usually five years. In return, their passage to Mauritius was paid and they received food, housing and a small wage. When they arrived, they were assigned to a plantation and had to fulfil their contract before they could move freely. Many workers found conditions very harsh and had little freedom during their contract period. The landing site for all incoming labourers was Aapravasi Ghat in Port Louis, which is now a UNESCO World Heritage Site."

- (i) What is an "indenture"? According to Source B, how long was the typical contract? [2]

- (ii) Name **two** benefits that indentured labourers received in exchange for their work. [2]

- (iii) What is Aapravasi Ghat? Why is it important today? [1]

- (d) Who was Adolphe de Plevitz? What did he do to help indentured labourers? [2]

SECTION C — GEOGRAPHY OF MAURITIUS: CLIMATE [25 marks]

6. Answer the following questions about the climate of Mauritius.

[14]

(a) Study the climate data table below and answer the questions. [6]

Month	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec
Temp (°C)	27	27	26	25	23	21	20	20	21	23	25	27
Rainfall (mm)	220	190	160	100	55	35	30	40	50	70	100	180

Table 1 — Average monthly temperature and rainfall for Port Louis

(i) Which month has the highest average temperature? [1]

(ii) Which month has the lowest average rainfall? [1]

(iii) What is the difference in temperature between the hottest and coolest months? Show your calculation. [2]

(iv) Using the data in Table 1, describe the relationship between temperature and rainfall. What does this tell us about the climate of Mauritius? [2]

(b) Explain what a trade wind is. From which direction do the south-east trade winds come? [2]

- (c) Describe what happens to Mauritius during a cyclone. Give **three** effects of a cyclone. [3]

- (d) How does the Mauritius Meteorological Services help the population prepare for cyclones? Give **two** measures. [2]

- (e) Tick ONE correct answer. The cyclone warning system in Mauritius goes from: [1]

- ☐ A Level 1 to Level 10
☐ B Class 1 to Class 4
☐ C Category A to Category F
☐ D Alert 1 to Alert 5

7. Answer the following questions about the natural resources of Mauritius.

[11]

- (a) Name **three** natural resources found in Mauritius or its surrounding waters. [3]

- (b) For much of its history, Mauritius depended on **one** main crop. Name this crop and explain why it was so important to the Mauritian economy. [3]

- (c) Explain what an Exclusive Economic Zone (EEZ) is and why Mauritius's EEZ is important. [3]

(d) Give **two** ways in which Mauritius is working to protect its natural environment. [2]

SECTION D — CIVICS AND HERITAGE [15 marks]

8. Answer the following questions about the government and constitution of Mauritius.

[8]

- (a) In which year did Mauritius gain independence from Britain? [1]

- (b) What is a constitution? Give **one** thing guaranteed by the Constitution of Mauritius. [2]

- (c) Name **three** branches of the government of Mauritius and briefly state the role of each. [3]

- (d) How often are general elections held in Mauritius? [1]

- (e) Who has the right to vote in Mauritian elections? Give **one** criterion. [1]

9. Answer the following questions about Mauritian cultural heritage.

[7]

- (a) Name the **two** UNESCO World Heritage Sites of Mauritius. [2]

- (b) Explain in your own words the historical importance of Aapravasi Ghat. Why was it inscribed as a UNESCO World Heritage Site in 2006? [3]

- (c) Tick ONE correct answer. Abolition Day is celebrated in Mauritius on: [1]

- ☐ A 12 March
☐ B 1 February
☐ C 2 November
☐ D 1 August

- (d) Name **one** important heritage festival or cultural celebration in Mauritius and state the community it belongs to. [1]

End of Paper 2 — Check your work before handing in. Total: 100 marks.

Mark Scheme — Specimen Paper 2 (2026)

For teacher / parent use only. This mark scheme is a guide. Accept any reasonable answer that demonstrates correct understanding. Award marks generously for responses that show understanding even if the exact wording differs.

Q	Answer	Marks
1(a)	Central Plateau / the uplands / the interior	1
1(b)	The west / western coastal areas / leeward side	1
1(c)	South-east / SE	1
1(d)	South-east trade winds bring moist air from the ocean (1); the air rises over the mountains on the east side and rain falls (orographic rainfall) (1); the west side is in the rain shadow (1)	3
1(e)	Rain shadow effect	1
1(f)	North or west of the island (1); these areas are drier and more sheltered / have lower rainfall which suits sugar cane (1)	2
1(g)	November to April (accept any months within the hot/wet season)	1
1(h)	Any two: cyclones; floods; heavy rain/strong winds; drought (in dry season) (1 each)	2
2(a)	Any two: Rodrigues; Agalega; Cargados Carajos (St Brandon); Chagos (accept Tromelin with note) (1 each)	2
2(b)	C — 2,040 km ²	1
2(c)	Any two: Réunion (France); Madagascar; India; Seychelles; Maldives (1 each)	2
2(d)	Approximately 20°S latitude; 57°E longitude (1 each; accept reasonable approximations)	2
2(e)	Strategic location on trade routes between Europe and Asia/India (1); natural harbour for ships to restock food and water (1); military base to protect trade routes (1)	3
2(f)	Any one: sheltered bay / calm water / deep water; surrounded by hills that protect from wind and waves	1
2(g)	Any two: fishing/seafood; shipping/trade; tourism; Exclusive Economic Zone resources (oil/minerals) (1 each)	2
3(a)	1810	1
3(b)	Cap Malheureux (in the north of the island)	1
3(c)	Robert Farquhar (1); any one policy: kept French laws/Civil Code; allowed French language; promoted sugar industry; invited settlement (1)	2
3(d)	B — They wanted to keep the French-speaking settlers happy and prevent rebellion	1

Q	Answer	Marks
3(e)	Mauritius (1); Paris (1); Slavery abolished / Emancipation Act (1); free people/freed (1); 500,000 / half a million (accept 450,000–500,000) (1); India (1). Award 1 for each correct entry (max 5)	5
4(a)	1835	1
4(b)	A transition period after abolition (1); formerly enslaved people were required to continue working for their former owners for a set period to "learn" new skills / compensate owners for loss of labour (1)	2
4(c) (i)	Any two: could be bought and sold; beaten/punished; forced to work from sunrise to sunset; no legal rights; children enslaved (1 each)	2
4(c) (ii)	Maroons = enslaved people who escaped and lived free (1); mountains / forests of Le Morne Brabant area (1)	2
4(c) (iii)	Any two: music; dance; religion (1 each)	2
4(d)	1 February is Abolition Day (1); it marks the anniversary of the abolition of slavery in Mauritius in 1835 (1)	2
4(e)	Le Morne Cultural Landscape	1
4(f)	B — Enslaved people who escaped and lived in freedom	1
5(a)	After slavery was abolished, the sugar plantations needed workers (1); formerly enslaved people refused to continue working on the plantations / left (1)	2
5(b)	India (1); any one other: China; Madagascar; East Africa; Mozambique (1)	2
5(c) (i)	An indenture is a contract / legal agreement to work for a set period (1); five years (1)	2
5(c) (ii)	Any two: paid sea passage to Mauritius; food; housing; small wage (1 each)	2
5(c) (iii)	Aapravasi Ghat is the landing site in Port Louis for all indentured labourers (1); it is a UNESCO World Heritage Site because of its role in the history of indentured labour / world migration (accept any clear explanation)	1
5(d)	Adolphe de Plevitz was a Mauritian planter/activist who collected a petition of complaints from Indian workers (1); he sent it to the British government and fought for better working conditions and rights for indentured labourers (1)	2
6(a) (i)	January (or December) (accept any month with 27°C)	1
6(a) (ii)	July (30mm)	1
6(a) (iii)	27°C – 20°C = 7°C (1 for correct subtraction, 1 for correct answer)	2
6(a) (iv)	When temperatures are high (Nov–Apr) rainfall is also high; when temperatures are lower (May–Oct) rainfall is lower (1). This shows Mauritius has a tropical climate with a hot wet season and a cooler dry season (1)	2

Q	Answer	Marks
6(b)	Trade winds are steady winds that blow towards the equator (1); south-east (SE) (1)	2
6(c)	Any three: very strong winds; heavy rain; flooding; damage to buildings and crops; power cuts; rough seas (1 each)	3
6(d)	Any two: issuing cyclone class warnings; broadcasting warnings on radio/TV; schools and offices closed; people told to stay indoors; emergency services on alert (1 each)	2
6(e)	B — Class 1 to Class 4	1
7(a)	Any three: fish/marine resources; sugar cane; fresh water; basalt/rock; forests; coral reef fish (1 each)	3
7(b)	Sugar cane (1); provided income from sugar exports; employed most of the labour force; shaped the landscape and social history of Mauritius (up to 2 marks for clear explanation)	3
7(c)	EEZ = the sea area up to 200 nautical miles from the coast where Mauritius has exclusive rights over resources (1); Mauritius has a very large EEZ (about 2.3 million km ²) giving it rights to fish, minerals, and potential oil/gas (up to 2 marks for explanation of importance)	3
7(d)	Any two: national parks; marine protected areas; reforestation; banning plastic; eco-tourism; conservation of native species (1 each)	2
8(a)	1968	1
8(b)	A constitution is the highest law of a country that sets out the rights and duties of citizens and the structure of government (1); any one: freedom of speech; right to education; freedom of religion; right to vote (1)	2
8(c)	Legislature / National Assembly — makes laws (1); Executive / Government / Prime Minister — runs the country / implements policies (1); Judiciary / Courts — interprets and applies the law / ensures justice (1)	3
8(d)	Every five years	1
8(e)	Any one: Mauritian citizen; aged 18 or over; registered on the electoral roll	1
9(a)	Aapravasi Ghat (1); Le Morne Cultural Landscape (1)	2
9(b)	Aapravasi Ghat is where indentured labourers arrived in Mauritius (1); it is the starting point of one of the largest human migrations in modern history (1); it represents the labour and sacrifice of those who built modern Mauritius (1)	3
9(c)	B — 1 February	1
9(d)	Any one festival + its community: Diwali (Hindu); Eid (Muslim); Chinese New Year (Chinese community); Cavadee (Tamil); Christmas (Christian); Ugadi; Holi etc.	1